

Galaxy Grand(er)?

Samsung unveils its Galaxy Grand 2 without too many details on its actual availability <http://dgit.in/1dv3ioD>

**PS4 Upgrade**

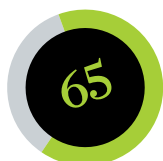
Ever thought '160 GB just isn't enough'? Read through this article to know how to upgrade your PS4 HDD <http://dgit.in/ps4hddplus>

AMD R9 290X 4GB

Hawaii is great this time of the year

The tech community awaited with bated breath when AMD announced that they'd be unveiling their next GPU lineup in Hawaii. There were only two models which had the next gen chipset while the rest were simply rebadged HD7000 chips. The R9 290X is the current flagship model that AMD have and it has been successful yet again at providing great performance in it's price bracket. This is one of the first cards to support Mantle, a new API by AMD which will be seen as competition to DirectX but Mantle will have direct GPU memory access.

When it comes to stock graphics cards, these models



Performance.....85
Value51
Build60

Specifications

Base clock: 1000MHz; **Memory clock:** 1250MHz; **Stream processors:** 2816; **Texture Units:** 176; **ROPs:** 64; **Manufacturing process:** 28nm. PCIe 3.0, 4K resolution support, Eyefinity support, 4GB Memory; **DirectX support:** 11.2; **OpenGL support:** 4.3; Mantle support; **Power Connectors:** 2x 8Pin; **TDP:** 300W;

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Price:
₹47,990

are built well and it's by no means mediocre. However, given what aftermarket cards look like in comparison to this does put it at a disadvantage. There is a single aluminium fin rack that sits over the GPU, VRM and the memory chips while a single fan channels air over the rack. Since the entire setup is enclosed in a housing the single fan does perform satisfactorily but at high loads the decibel level does become rather noticeable.

The card has 2816 stream processors, 176 texture units and 64 ROPs which puts it in league with what the competition has to offer. This card has the most number of ROPs and only dual chip graphics cards have more, the performance difference is clearly noticeable during OpenCL benchmarks.

Performance wise, this card is very close to the GTX Titan, the FPS scores are with 2-10 of each other, which is next to nothing given that these cards are churning a lot more. It's the price that makes a difference given that the R9 290 is slightly greater than half the price at which the Titan comes for. The only reason for which you'd pick a Titan is if you need the extra 2GB of video memory.

Mithun Mobandas

MSI R9 270X Hawk Edition

They hardly build stuff as good as this anymore



Price:
₹16,800
(+ Taxes)

The card is built like no other we've had in the past few months – which is very good. Even under full load, the card maintained temps under 60 deg C.

Performance wise the card doesn't differ much from a HD7870. It turns out that this is the card with the highest scores in the value for money category since it offers quite the performance at the price. Even the overall build quality of the card is way better than most cards given the lack of plastic as material for most of the body parts.



Performance.....66
Value90
Build68

Specifications

Bus standard: PCI Express 3.0; **Base clock:** 1100 MHz; **Memory clock:** 1400 MHz DDR5; **Memory:** 2048 MB GDDR5, CrossFireX support; **Stream processors:** 1280; **Texture units:** 80; **ROPs:** 32; **Connectivity ports:** HDMI, DVI-D, DVI-I, DP; **DirectX Support:** 11.2; **OpenGL Support:** 4.3; **Power Connectors:** 6 Pin x2; **TDP:** Approx 210 W; **Warranty:** 3 years

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Sapphire R9 280X Vapor-X

The coolest GPU we've tested this year



Price
₹27,000

The card is very well built as you can see from the image, reaching 59 deg C at peak load, the lowest we saw in all the cards tested. The card offers playable FPS through all AAA titles we tested so far. OpenCL benchmarks put it behind the R9 290 and way above the entire competition so it's not a bad choice for an overall great performer. Compared to a HD7970, this card does slightly better but at a lesser price. Buy this and game all AAA titles easily for a year.



Performance.....77
Value66
Build64

Specifications

Bus standard: PCI Express 3.0; **Base clock:** 1050 MHz; **Memory clock:** 1400 MHz DDR5; **Memory:** 2048 MB GDDR5, CrossFireX support; **Stream processors:** 2048; **Texture units:** 128; **ROPs:** 32; **Connectivity ports:** HDMI, DVI-D, DVI-I, DP; **DirectX Support:** 11.2; **OpenGL Support:** 4.3; **Power Connectors:** 8Pin x2; **TDP:** Approx 210 W; **Warranty:** 3 years

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